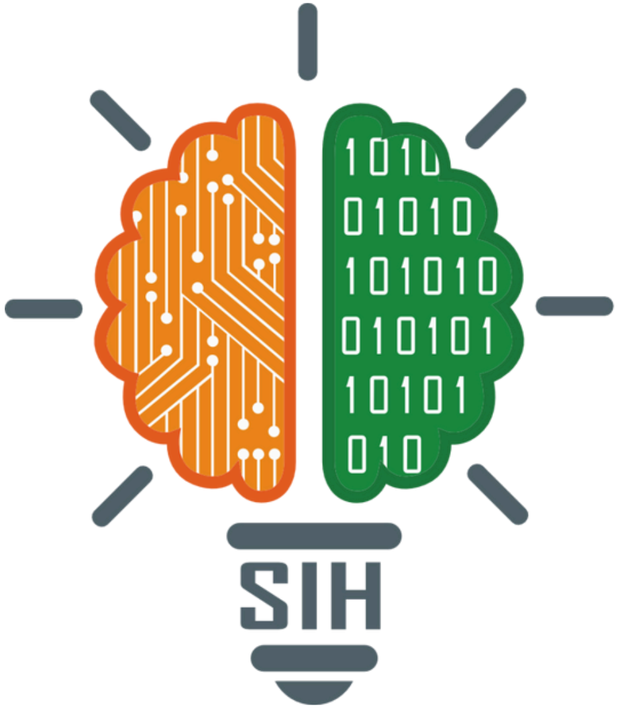
UKDICHE MODAK

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

- **Problem Statement ID – SIH26265**
- **Problem Statement Title- Streamline of security deposit / FDR Portal**
- **Theme- Smart Automation**
- **PS Category- Software**
- **Team ID- 3B0D5B**
- **Team Name - Ukdiche_Modak**



UKDICHE MODAK

SAKSHYA-TRAIL

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

SOLUTION

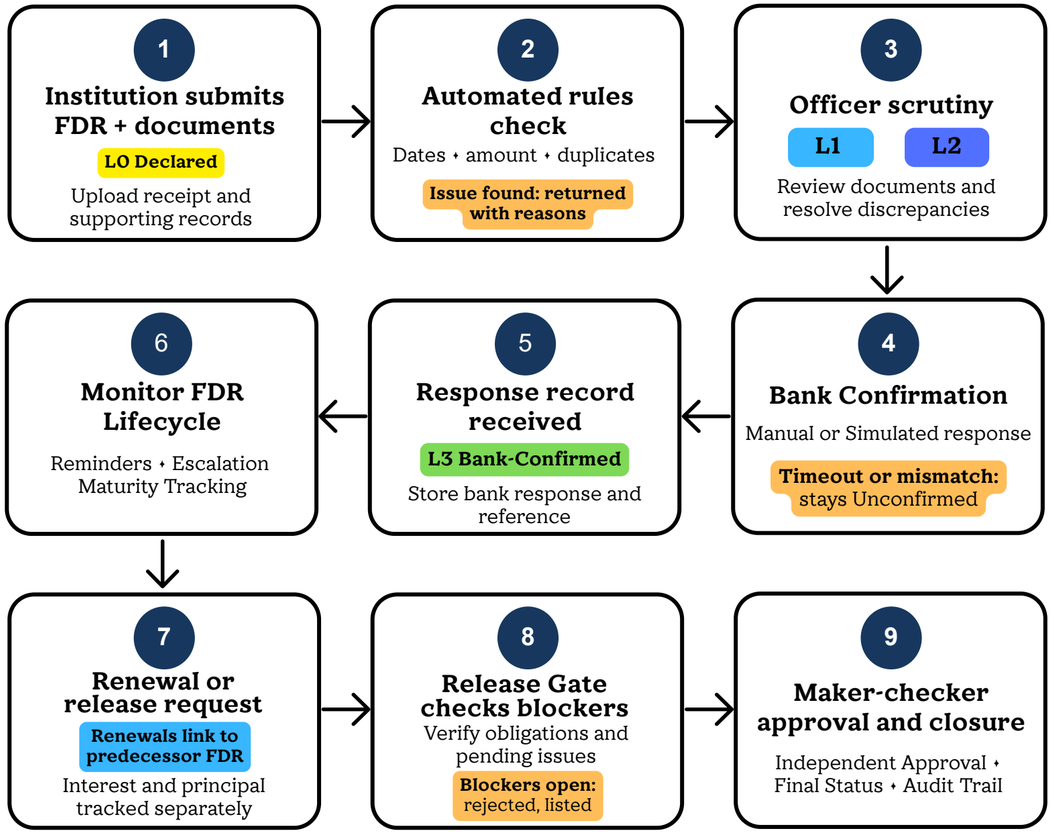
Sakshya-Trail is a trust-first lifecycle-integrity platform that lets the AICTE Regulation Bureau track every security deposit and FDR from submission to release, with evidence provenance and a verifiable audit trail.

- Trust Ledger with L0–L3 trust levels: every field stores its source, actor and time, and rises from Declared to Bank-confirmed only through evidence. Level 3 needs a **verification-response record**, enforced by a database constraint.
- Explainable discrepancy flags: rule-based date, amount, duplicate and **SHA-256 file-hash checks record the rule**, evidence and next action. record the rule, evidence and next action.
- Deadline and renewal engine: a daily scheduler tracks maturity and validity, sends configurable reminders and escalates overdue cases. Idempotent jobs prevent duplicates, and each renewal becomes a **new linked record**. Rules are versioned Policy-as-Data [4].
- Release Gate with Maker-Checker: a state machine and readiness checklist reject approval on the server while mandatory blockers are open. Requester and Competent Authority (the AICTE officer who approves release) stay separate, and **AI and heuristic flags are advisory only; people decide**.

We solve the problem with a unified, trust-first lifecycle layer for AICTE deposits: **one centralized repository** replacing fragmented records and manual correspondence with provenance-tagged evidence, automated deadlines, gated release and a hash-chained audit trail. It is designed to **complement, not replace**, existing AICTE systems[2][3].

USER FLOW DIAGRAM

Every step writes a hash-chained audit event



WHY WE STAND OUT ?

Prototype on **synthetic data.** record the rule, evidence and next action. **No live AICTE or bank integration is assumed**.

Confirmed has an expiry

L3 carries a **last-confirmed date** and turns Stale after a **configurable** period. A reported 2024 case: closed 10 May, surfaced 2 July, 53 days later [16].

Interest tracked apart from principal

Renewals are linked to previous FDRs, with **interest** payable to AICTE and **principal** payable to the trust recorded in **separate ledgers** [21] [22].

Try to break it

A **proof panel** attempts a bypass release, a silent L3, a cross-tenant read and a log edit. Edits through the app are blocked; direct database tampering is detected. The audit is **tamper-evident**, not tamper-proof [12].

Policy impact preview

Change a term, window or amount table and see which **instruments** are **affected before publishing**. The term was 8 years in older letters and 10 years in APH 2020–21 [4][21].

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TECHNICAL APPROACH

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

1. Submit | 2. Upload | 3. Validate | 4. Verify | 5. Monitor | 6. Renew | 7. Release Gate | 8. Approve | 9. Approve and Audit

1 Users and External Resources

Actors: Role Scoped

- Institution User
- Scrutiny Officer
- Branch Head
- Competant Authority
- Admin (System Level)
- Advisory Panel
- Function Officers

WEB CLIENT

- Web Client (Browser)
- HTTPS to the portal

External Sources

- AI Behind Adapters
- None Assumed

Issuing Bank

- Optional, external
- Future, authorized only

AICTE Web Portal

- Future, Authorized
- CSV import used now

Identity Provider

- FUTURE: prototype uses local authentication

Whatsapp/SMS

- Email (SMTP) used
- SMS/Whatsapp Mock

2 Presentation Layer

User Interface

- React
- Typescript
- Tailwind CSS
- UI enforcement rules

Institution Portal

- Submit Instrument
- Upload Docs
- See Checklist
- Correct returned submissions

Officer / Authority / Auditor Console

- Instrument register (identifiers masked in lists)
- Instrument detail: field-level trust labels.
- Discrepancy flags wiht reasons
- Release Blockers
- Risk-ranked work queue
- Role-based dashboards
- Audit-chain verification screen.

Labels shown on screen

- LO-L3 trust badge on every field
- SIMULATED badge on simulated bank responses
- Advisory: Human Review Required on AI/heuristic flags

3 Application Layer

API layer: REST API + OpenAPI

- Authentication | RBAC + institution/office record scoping on EVERY endpoint
- Request validation
- Safe denial and audit of authorization failures

Seven domain modules (logical boundaries, one deployable)

M1 IDENTITY, INSTITUTION AND INSTRUMENT REGISTRY

- Institution master; stable instrument ID
- Admin state apart from trust
- Duplicates flagged, never auto-merged
- Field history

M2 SECURE DOCUMENT INTAKE AND EVIDENCE INTELLIGENCE

- Allow-listed types
- Malware scan
- Private storage
- Re-upload = new version with SHA-256
- Completeness checklist
- Optional OCR suggestions, human-confirmed

M3 VALIDATION, DISCREPANCY AND EXPLAINABLE INTELLIGENCE

- Rules Engine on effective policy version
- Fields, dates, amount vs policy, name, duplicate ref, file hash
- Flag = rule ID + evidence + severity
- Advisory only

M4 TRUST, PROVENANCE AND VERIFICATION DESK (TRUST LEDGER)

- Per-field provenance
- L0 Declared
- L1 Document-consistent
- L2 Officer-verified
- L3 Bank-confirmed (needs response record)
- Timeouts never upgrade trust

M5 LIFECYCLE ORCHESTRATION AND RENEWAL

- State machine
- Daily maturity monitoring
- Idempotent reminders
- Escalation
- Catch-up
- Renewal = NEW instrument linked to predecessor (acyclic)

M6 RELEASE / REFUND CASE MANAGEMENT

- Checklist and readiness engine
- Release Gate rejects approval while mandatory blockers are open
- Maker-Checker
- No AI in gate path

Command Center, Search, Reporting and Audit

- Role scoped dashboards
- Search and filters
- Reports (prending verification, upcoming maturities, documents, missing documents, internetions), Audit Chain Verification Screen

4 Data Layer

POSTGRESQL

- Records, events, policy versions, audit events
- Relational integrity
- Database constraints for uniqueness, acyclic lineage and L3 evidence
- App role has no UPDATE/DELETE on audit tables

DOCUMENT STORE (S3-COMPATIBLE; MINIO LOCALLY)

- Encrypted, versioned binary documents
- Signed, time-limited links
- No public paths
- Hash and metadata held in PostgreSQL

Optional PostgreSQL row-level security as defence in depth.

5 Workers Verification and Adaption Layer

BACKGROUND WORKER

- Scheduler (APScheduler / Celery Beat; Redis only if needed)
- Daily maturity computation
- Reminders at policy intervals
- Escalation
- Bounded retries
- Catch-up

IDEMPOTENCY KEY

- instrument + event + interval + recipient
- Sample intervals:
- 90/60/30/15/7 days: illustrative, not official AICTE rules.
- Notifications:
- In-app + SMTP email
- Delivery status
- Retries
- SMS/WhatsApp MOCK

Verification Adapters (One Interface)

- Manual evidence path: MANUAL
- SIMULATED bank adapter: DEMO ONLY, not real bank confirmation
- Authorized live bank adapter: FUTURE, not assumed to exist

Optional AI Services (No Database Credentials)

- OCR (PaddleOCR / docTR / Tesseract) or approved vision model: suggestions only, tagged OCR-Extracted / Vision-LLM-Extracted
- LLM helper: read-only filter mapping, grounded drafts, drafted notices
- Phase B/C, optional
- Cannot authenticate an FDR or authorize a release.

6 Implementation Process

1 IDENTITY, ACCESS & REGISTRY [M1]

BUILDS: Role-based login, institution registry and unique instrument IDs | **HOW:** Enforces role and institution-level access; flags probable duplicates and maintains field history | **OUTPUT:** Trusted instrument records with controlled access and traceable changes

2 SECURE DOCUMENT INTAKE [M2]

BUILDS: Private, versioned document storage and completeness checks. | **HOW:** Validates file types, scans for malware, computes SHA-256 hashes and checks required documents against case type and policy. | **OUTPUT:** Immutable document versions with present, missing, unreadable or incorrect-category status.

3 VALIDATION, DISCREPANCY & AI ASSISTANCE [M3]

BUILDS: Policy-driven validation rules and explainable discrepancy detection. | **HOW:** Checks fields, dates, amounts, names, duplicate references and file hashes; optional OCR/LLM suggests extracted data for human verification. | **OUTPUT:** Evidence-backed flags with severity and next actions; AI suggestions remain advisory and never establish trust.

4 TRUST LEDGER & VERIFICATION [M4]

BUILDS: Field-level provenance and a four-level trust model (L0–L3). | **HOW:** Records declared, document-consistent, officer-verified and bank-confirmed evidence; simulated bank responses are clearly labelled. Timeouts never increase trust. | **OUTPUT:** Auditable evidence for every trust level; L3 requires a recorded verification response.

5 LIFECYCLE, RENEWAL & NOTIFICATIONS [M5]

BUILDS: Instrument lifecycle state machine, maturity monitoring and reminder scheduler. | **HOW:** Runs idempotent reminder jobs, escalation and bounded retries; links each renewal to its predecessor as a new instrument. | **OUTPUT:** Reliable reminders, no duplicate notifications and complete renewal lineage.

6 RELEASE / REFUND & AUTHORIZATION GATE [M6]

BUILDS: Readiness checklist, release gate and Maker–Checker workflow. | **HOW:** Blocks release while mandatory requirements remain unmet; an authorized Competent Authority makes the decision. AI cannot approve or bypass the gate. | **OUTPUT:** Controlled release decisions with actor, timestamp, reason and policy-version traceability.

7 COMMAND CENTER, REPORTING & AUDIT [M7]

BUILDS: Role-based dashboards, search, reports and audit-chain verification. | **HOW:** Tracks pending verification, upcoming maturities, missing documents and interventions; records append-only, hash-chained events. | **OUTPUT:** Operational visibility, traceable decisions and tamper-evident audit history.

8 SHARED SECURITY, INTEGRATIONS & QUALITY

BUILDS: Central policy configuration, security controls, testing and integration adapters | **HOW:** Applies server-side authorization, encryption and policy versioning; tests APIs, workflows, cross-tenant denial and audit integrity. | **OUTPUT:** Secure, tested, integration-ready architecture.

7 TECH STACK

Frontend (React)

- React, TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS
- Why: Typed console for trust labels

Backend (FastAPI)

- FastAPI, Rest API
- OpenAPI
- Why: Types Validation, One Language

Database (Postgres)

- PostgreSQL
- Why: Constraints, transactions, relational integrity

Documentation Store

- S3: Compatible Store
- Why: Versioned, Encrypted, Signed URLS

Worker/Scheduler

- APScheduler/ Celeray Bell.
- Why: Reminders, Escalation, Retries

Docker Compose

- Why: Unified, local, sharability, effective

Optional AI

- PaddleOCR / Tesseract
- Vision LLM
- Why: Suggestions only, human centered

Docker Tesseract

PaddleOCR / Tesseract
Why: LLM and LLM Helper

NOTIFICATIONS

- SMTP Mail
- SMS / Whatsapp Mock
- Why: No unavailable channel assumed

SECURITY

- RBAC
- TLS
- Encryption at rest
- Why: Tamper evident audit trial

DEVOPS and QA

- Docker Compose
- Unit/Integration/Scenario Testing

ASYNC

- Technologies: APSchedular / Celery Beat (Redis if needed)
- Purpose: Remindereds, escalation, retries, catch-up

FEASIBILITY AND VIABILITY

FEASIBILITY

Technical Feasibility

The core lifecycle runs on mature open-source components: **React + TypeScript, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, MinIO/S3-compatible storage** and an APScheduler/Celery **background worker**, in a **modular monolith** on Docker Compose. The State Machine, Rules Engine and scheduler are standard engineering, and the core needs **no AI/ML and no bank API**.

Operational Feasibility

AICTE already runs online deposit payment and release applications [2][3][9], so Sakshya-Trail is designed to **complement them** through CSV import and an **API Adapter Pattern**, not replace them. Officers stay in control through **Human-in-the-Loop** review, **Maker-Checker** and Competent Authority approval, with role-based dashboards for every user.

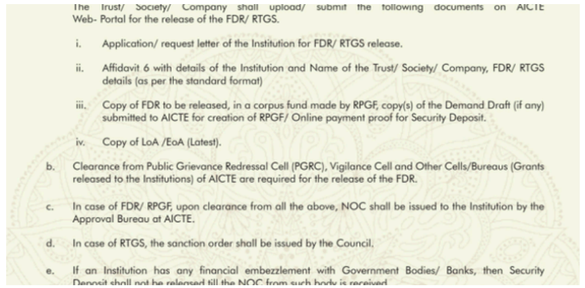
Economic Feasibility

The stack is open-source, so the core components carry **no per-seat licensing**, and the prototype deploys as a single Docker Compose stack. Prototype effort is **about 30 person-days (our estimate, ±30%)**, with optional AI features feature-flagged and cut first.

Data & Regulatory Feasibility

Built for the DPDP Rules, 2025: notified in November 2025 with an 18-month phased compliance period (full duties by 13 May 2027) and penalties up to ₹250 crore for failing to maintain reasonable security safeguards . We design in **encryption, data minimisation, sensitive-data masking, access logging** and configurable retention. The prototype uses **synthetic test data** only, and applicability to AICTE needs legal review.

Source: AICTE Approval Process Handbook 2024–27, Release of Security Deposit [6]



The trust/ Society/ Company shall upload/ submit the following documents on AICTE Web- Portal for the release of the FDR/ RTGS.

i. Application/ request letter of the Institution for FDR/ RTGS release.

ii. Affidavit 6 with details of the Institution and Name of the Trust/ Society/ Company, FDR/ RTGS details (as per the standard format)

iii. Copy of FDR to be released, in a corpus fund made by RPGF, copy(s) of the Demand Draft (if any) submitted to AICTE for creation of RPGF/ Online payment proof for Security Deposit.

iv. Copy of LoA /EoA (Latest).

b. Clearance from Public Grievance Redressal Cell (PGRC), Vigilance Cell and Other Cells/Bureaus (Grants released to the Institutions) of AICTE are required for the release of the FDR.

c. In case of FDR/ RPGF, upon clearance from all the above, NOC shall be issued to the Institution by the Approval Bureau at AICTE.

d. In case of RTGS, the sanction order shall be issued by the Council.

e. If an Institution has any financial embezzlement with Government Bodies/ Banks, then Security Deposit shall not be released till the NOC from such body is received.

- **Market Viability to Institutional Need & Adoption Potential.**
  AICTE's website listed 8,489 technical institutions in April 2026 [7], an indicator of institutional scale, not the number of FDRs. No AICTE-specific market size, losses or savings are assumed.

- **Institutional Viability**
  Deposit payment and release are part of AICTE's approval process [2][3]. **Versioned Policy-as-Data** accommodates changing deposit rules across handbook cycles [4]. Pilot readiness depends on validation with AICTE.

CHALLENGES

1. No Verified Bank-Confirmation Channel

We found no evidence of an FDR bank-confirmation API, and the nearest national platform, NeSL e-BG, covers **bank guarantees, not FDRs [24]**. Account Aggregator shares data only with **financial-sector-regulated entities [8]**, so direct AICTE access is unconfirmed.

2. Deposit Rules Vary by Year and Case

Exemptions and balance-deposit provisions **differed across handbook cycles** [4], and deposit amounts are held as policy data with effective dates. Hard-coded rules would go stale and mis-gate a release.

3. Reliable Deadlines at Scale

Five sample reminders per instrument (90/60/30/15/7 days, **illustrative, not official**) means about **5,000 scheduled reminders per 1,000 instruments** (our arithmetic), before escalations. Duplicates, outages or silent failures would erode trust.

4. Protecting Sensitive Financial Data

FDR scans, bank details and approvals are confidential financial records. **Cross-institution exposure, over-broad admin rights** or a single person preparing and approving a release would be serious control failures.

OUR PLAN TO OVERCOME THESE CHALLENGES

1. Adapter-Based Verification

L3 needs a **verification-response record**. Manual evidence works today, a labelled **SIMULATED** adapter demos the flow, and a timeout shows **Source Unavailable**, never confirmed.

2. Policy-as-Data, Versioned

Required documents, amounts, intervals and checklists live in **JSON Policy Configuration** with effective dates. Every decision stores its **policy version**.

3. Idempotent Scheduler with Catch-Up

One reminder per instrument, event, interval and recipient, so reruns create **no duplicates**. After an outage, a **catch-up run** issues missed reminders once.

4. Security by Design

RBAC, Tenant Isolation, Least Privilege and **Separation of Duties [11][6]**, with masked identifiers and a **hash-chained audit log [12]**, enforced server-side from day one.

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IMPACTS AND BENEFITS

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

OPERATIONAL BENEFITS

Streamlined FDR lifecycle management through centralized records, document-completeness checks, maturity alerts and renewal lineage—reducing dependence on scattered manual tracking.

TRUST & GOVERNANCE

Evidence provenance, explainable discrepancy flags and role-separated approvals separate declared information from verified evidence, supporting accountable decisions

INSTITUTIONAL BENEFITS

A shared view of pending cases, release blockers and audit history helps institutions and AICTE officers track the deposit lifecycle clearly.

STAKEHOLDERS & EXPECTED IMPACTS

Sample Scenario

1. Institution submits FDR details and supporting documents. Missing fields or documents are flagged for correction.

INSTITUTION SUBMISSION

SUBMISSION & RULE CHECK
Checks document completeness, identifies inconsistencies and flags approaching maturity for officer review.

2. Sakshya-Trail checks submitted documents against configured rules and flags missing information, inconsistencies and approaching maturity dates for review.

OFFICER REVIEW

EVIDENCE & RULE VALIDATION
Document completeness, explainable discrepancy flags and maturity monitoring.

3. The system presents supporting evidence, outstanding clearances and release requirements so authorized officers can review each case.

COMPETENT AUTHORITY

RELEASE READINESS CHECK
Required documents, pending clearances, release blockers and authorized human decisions.

4. Authorized users can access consolidated FDR lifecycle records, case status, evidence history and audit information through centralized reports.

Auditor / Management

LIFECYCLE AUDIT TRAIL
Traceable status changes, supporting evidence, policy versions and decision history.

COMPLETE RECORDS & EVIDENCE-BASED SCRUTINY
Structured submissions and explainable discrepancy flags help identify missing information earlier, reduce avoidable back-and-forth and support officer review.

FOCUSED OFFICER REVIEW
Clear discrepancy flags and visible supporting evidence help officers prioritize reviews, identify missing information and understand why a record needs attention.

CONTROLLED & TRACEABLE RELEASE
Visible requirements & pending clearances help competent authorities identify unresolved issues & make accountable decisions with traceable record.

TRANSPARENT OVERSIGHT & REPORTING
- Centralized case tracking improves pending-case visibility and lifecycle monitoring.
- Traceable evidence and authorized actions strengthen auditability, accountability, and reporting.

OUR PROMISE

Declared ≠ Confirmed
Know what is submitted. Know what is verified. Never silently lose a lifecycle event.

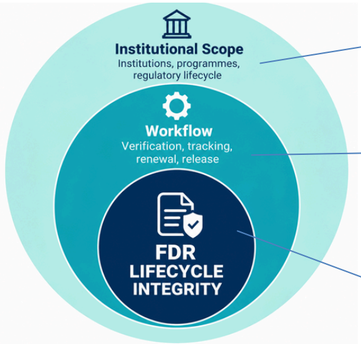
Human-authorized decisions · Versioned policy rules · Tamper-evident audit trail



UN SDG 16 — Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions
Supports alignment with Target 16.6: effective, accountable and transparent institutions. [10]

AICTE Security Deposit Lifecycle

AICTE prescribes security-deposit requirements and a formal release process involving supporting documents, departmental clearances and, where applicable, an NOC. These requirements create a clear opportunity for structured FDR records, maturity tracking, evidence traceability and release-workflow visibility.



AICTE rules provide for security deposits to be held for 10 years, with release subject to prescribed conditions [9][21].

Release requires supporting documents and clearances from AICTE's Public Grievance Redressal Cell, Vigilance Cell and relevant other cells/bureaus [9].

Where financial embezzlement involving government bodies or banks exists, AICTE rules require an NOC from the concerned body before the security deposit can be released [9].

1 Institutional closures (reported)
342
AICTE-approved institutions closed, 2024-25 to 2026-27 (83 + 124 + 135) [15]

2 Potential ecosystem (reported)
5,875
Approved engineering institutions only, 2025-26 [16]

3 Overall scale
8,489
AICTE technical institutions, April 2026 [7]

4 Documented risk
Bhopal: fake ₹35 lakh FDR reached AICTE (Lok Sabha, 2014) [18].
IDFC First Bank paid ₹645 crore towards Chandigarh branch fraud claims [19].

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DEMO LINK

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